

Fit for 55 as the First Bounded Population

Corpus selection, coding architecture and AI-assisted workflow for regulatory intermediation research

Prepared for discussion with David Levi-Faur

Population first

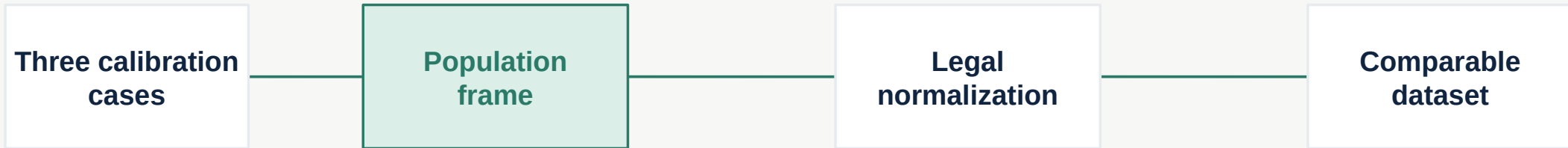
Evidence-linked coding

AI as research instrument

12 Sep 2026

The methodological move

The current cases proved that R-I-T coding is feasible. The next step is not simply to add more interesting laws, but to define the population before looking for intermediaries.



Risk avoided

Selection on the dependent variable: choosing laws because they already appear to contain verifiers, auditors, certification bodies or other intermediaries.

Why Fit for 55 first?

European Green Deal

Broad political-regulatory universe

Fit for 55

First bounded legislative population

Institutional boundary defined ex ante
Official Commission sampling frame
High internal variation across regulatory architectures
Direct link to European Climate Law targets

Not keyword-driven

Comparable files

Scalable design

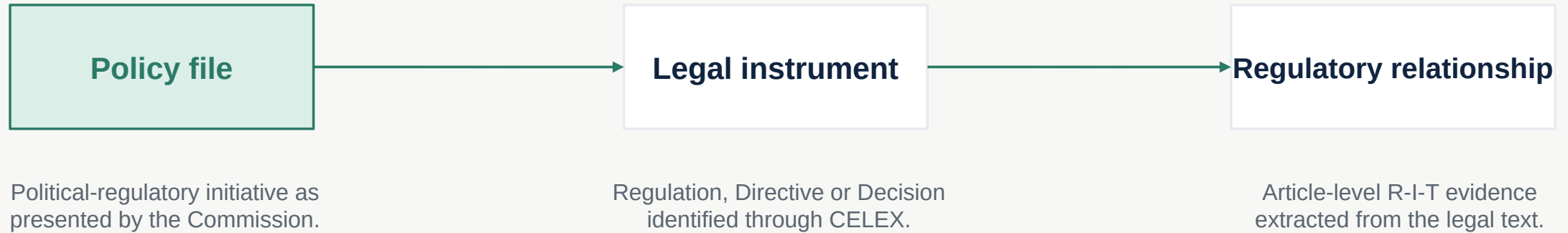
How the documents would be obtained



The AI does not select corpus membership. It can help resolve, check and document the legal instruments after the institutional frame is fixed.

Output: FIT_FOR_55_POPULATION_MASTER.csv

Legal normalization rules



Amending acts and consolidated texts should be recorded separately: the adopted Fit for 55 instrument is the observation; consolidated versions may be auxiliary interpretive texts.

Lexical screening

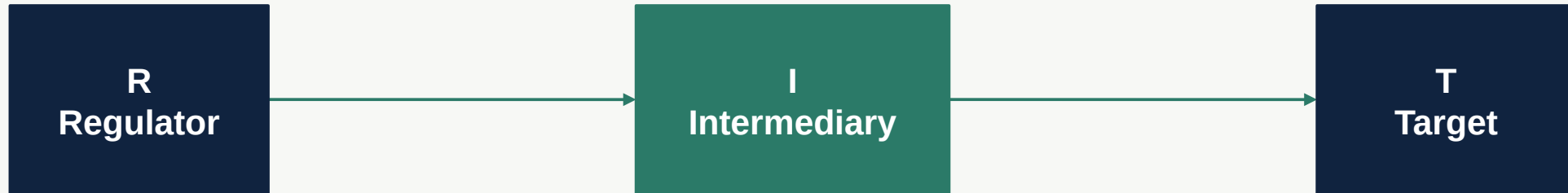
Strings are used to locate candidate passages. They are not evidence of intermediation by themselves.

Reporting	report, submit, notify, disclose, transmit, register	Conformity	conformity assessment, notified body
Monitoring	monitor, supervise, inspect, control, surveillance	Accreditation	accredit, accredited, accreditation body
Verification	verify, validate, verifier, verification	Rating / ranking	rating, ranking, score, benchmark, index, label
Audit / assurance	audit, auditor, assurance, independent review, external review	Third-party roles	third party, external body, recognised organisation
Certification	certify, certificate, certification body, attestation		

keyword hit != regulatory relationship

Coding architecture

A relation is coded only when textual evidence supports the mediated regulatory link.



FUNCTION

monitoring / compliance / enforcement / information

MECHANISM

reporting / certification / auditing / assurance / rating

STATUS

mandated / permitted / voluntary-emergent

ORIENTATION

regulator-facing / target-facing / bidirectional

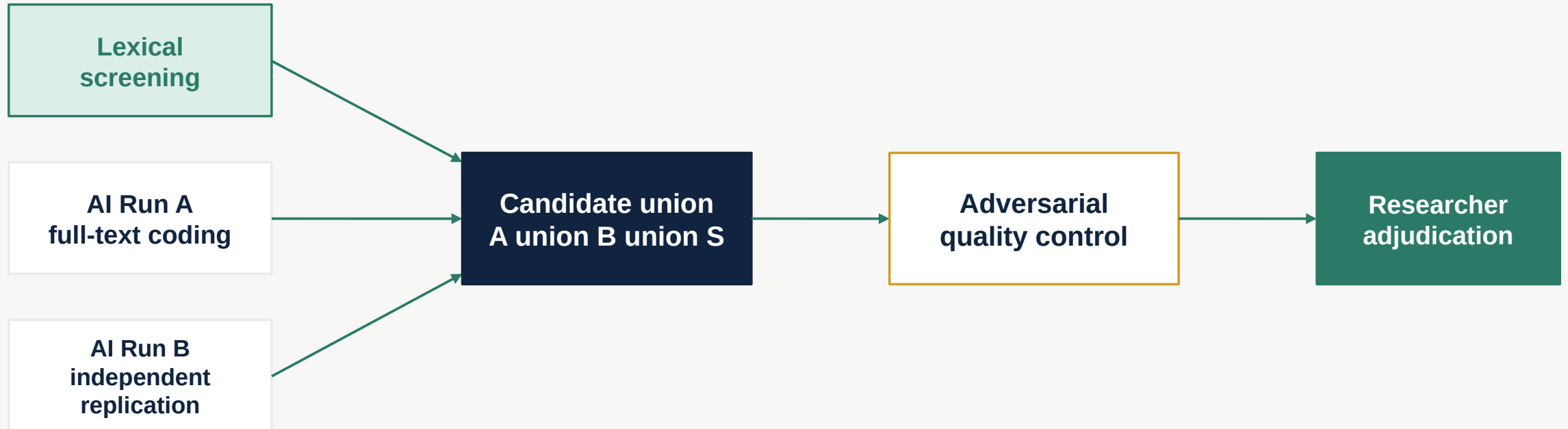
DISCRETION

informational / evaluative / authoritative

ACCOUNTABILITY

supervision / accreditation / sanctions / review

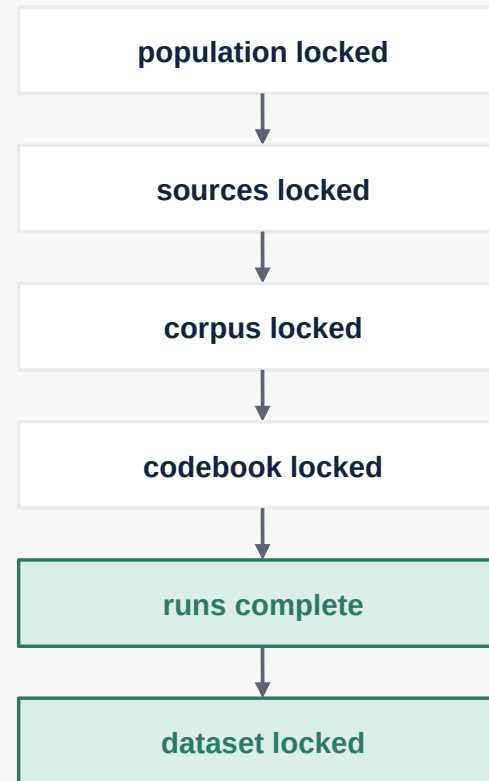
AI-assisted coding workflow



The model proposes; the evidence constrains; the researcher adjudicates.

VS Code working model

```
fit-for-55-rit/  
  README.md  
  AGENTS.md  
  CODEBOOK.md  
  LEGAL_NORMALIZATION_RULES.md  
  config/  
    population.yaml  
    strings.yaml  
    prompts.yaml  
  01_population/  
  02_source/  
  03_normalized/  
  04_screening/  
  05_ai_runs/  
  06_candidates/  
  07_human_adjudication/  
  08_final_dataset/  
  scripts/  
  logs/
```



Immutable logs: model, prompt version, codebook version, corpus hash, timestamp, output file

Immediate deliverables

- | | | |
|---|---------------------------------|---|
| 1 | Population master | Fit for 55 files reconciled across Commission pages and EUR-Lex/CELEX. |
| 2 | Legal normalization memo | Rules for amendments, consolidated texts, recitals and annexes. |
| 3 | Codebook v1 | R-I-T relation schema plus mechanisms, discretion, accountability and status. |
| 4 | Pilot run | CBAM recoded from scratch using the new workflow. |
| 5 | Scale decision | After error audit, decide census vs stratified sample. |

Ask David: confirm Fit for 55 as the first bounded population before expanding to the broader Green Deal.

One-minute formulation for David

I propose using Fit for 55 as our first bounded regulatory population. The population would be defined independently of intermediaries, using the Commission tracker and the Legal Documents collection, and then normalized through EUR-Lex and CELEX.

Coding would combine lexical screening, two independent AI-assisted full-text readings, adversarial quality control and researcher adjudication. Keywords would only increase recall; AI would assist reading and coding, but would not define the corpus or establish empirical ground truth.

This gives us a reproducible bridge from EU legal texts to a comparative dataset on regulatory intermediation.

Sources and safeguards

Primary institutional sources

European Commission - Fit for 55: Delivering on the proposals
European Commission - Legal documents on Delivering the
European Green Deal
EUR-Lex / CELEX - official legal texts and metadata

Methodological safeguards

Population defined before screening
Official text frozen and hashed
Every relation linked to provision and evidence
Independent model runs kept immutable
Researcher adjudication before final dataset

Core principle: no corpus membership by expected presence of intermediaries.

Source URLs:

https://commission.europa.eu/topics/climate-action/delivering-european-green-deal/fit-55-delivering-proposals_en
https://commission.europa.eu/publications/legal-documents-delivering-european-green-deal_en